

The camera opens inside a small training gym.

Lena Wilde sits on the mat against the bottom turnbuckle, still in her training clothes, phone propped against one knee. Her bag is beside her.

Sudio is on FaceTime.

**SUDIO:** "You look miserable."

**LENA:** "Been a rough couple weeks."

**SUDIO:** "You almost won the Fighting Spirit Championship."

**LENA:** "Almost."

Lena fidgets with the hand not holding the phone.

**LENA:** "Then I went back home and got bounced out of a gauntlet."

**SUDIO:** "Part of the process. You know that. You're gonna get knocked down a lot."

Lena gives a small shrug.

**SUDIO:** "But that's not what I wanna know."

Lena looks at the screen.

**SUDIO:** "What was your first thought when you saw the card? Your name in the main event of a **UNIQUE** show against the World Champion."

Lena doesn't answer right away.



LENA WILDE



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She glances towards her bag.

**LENA:** "You want the honest answer?"

**SUDIO:** "Always."

Another pause.

**LENA:** "Pride."

Sudio smiles a little.

**SUDIO:** "That's not exactly a confession."

**LENA:** "No. I mean... pride in the ugly way. It's not just that..."

she pauses

**LENA:** "It's stupid..."

**SUDIO:** "Usually means it's worth saying."

Lena looks away from the screen.

**LENA:** "CFW is home. I know that place. I know who I am there."

She pauses.

**LENA:** "Maybe too much."

Sudio stays quiet.

**LENA:** "Then I come here and everything feels bigger. Different. I'm not walking into my building anymore. I'm not the girl everybody already knows."

She looks towards her bag once again.

**LENA:** "And I think I liked that more than I should've."

**SUDIO:** "Liked what?"



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**LENA:** "Seeing my name there."

A pause.

**LENA:** "Main event. World Champion."

She exhales, almost embarrassed now.

**LENA:** "I told myself I shouldn't be ashamed of being proud of that. That I stepped outside my comfort zone and earned something."

**SUDIO:** "That doesn't sound terrible."

**LENA:** "Yeah, well..."

She reaches over and pulls the main event card from her bag and holds it to the camera.

**LENA:** "I carried this thing around for a week."

Sudio gives her a look.

**LENA:** "I'm serious."

She studies the card.

**LENA:** "I kept looking at it. My name. Main event."

Another pause.

**LENA:** "And I didn't train."

The line sits for a while

**SUDIO:** "Wait. What?"

And Lena confesses:

**LENA:** "A whole week."

**LENA:** "I don't know what it was. Ego, I guess. I just really liked how my name looked up there."



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**SUDIO:** "Aiko Tsukishima."

Lena stops. Silence

**LENA:** "What?"

**SUDIO:** "Aiko Tsukishima."

A pause.

**SUDIO:** "You know who that is?"

Lena's expression changes.

**LENA:** "No."

**SUDIO:** "Shimoda paralyzed her."

lands like a punch to the gut.

Now Lena's whole mood shifts.

**SUDIO:** "I'm not telling you that to scare you."

**LENA:** "I didn't know."

**SUDIO:** "I know."

**SUDIO:** "She was small. Tough. Stubborn. Sound familiar?... She kept coming back because she thought if she had enough heart, eventually he'd be the one who broke."

Lena looks down.

**SUDIO:** "He wasn't."

A pause.

**SUDIO:** "And when it was over, he just moved on."

Lena doesn't answer.



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**SUDIO:** "That's what you missed."

Lena looks back at the screen.

**LENA:** "I spent a week staring at my own name."

Sudio stays quiet.

**LENA:** "Jesus Christ."

She glances toward the card.

**LENA:** "I didn't even know hers."

**SUDIO:** "You know I believe in you."

**LENA:** "I know."

**SUDIO:** "And as much as I hate this miracle underdog shit you do..."

Lena looks back at the screen.

**SUDIO:** "I've seen it too many times to call it bullshit."

A moment.

**SUDIO:** "There is nobody with more heart than you."

Sudio pauses.

**SUDIO:** "But Lena... she had heart too."

That lands.

**SUDIO:** "That's the whole fucking point."

Lena says nothing.

**SUDIO:** "Heart didn't save her. It gave her the courage to keep coming until Shimoda finally caught her."



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A pause.

**SUDIO:** "So no, I'm not gonna sit here and tell you your heart makes you safe."

Sudio leans closer to the screen.

**SUDIO:** "I'm telling you it's why I believe you can stand across from anybody."

Another beat.

**SUDIO:** "But it's time to bring your head with it."

Lena looks up.

**SUDIO:** "Forget the card. Forget the main event. Forget what beating the World Champion would mean."

**SUDIO:** "You need to see *the devil* standing across from you."

Lena nods faintly.

**SUDIO:** "I'm on my way."

**LENA:** "Sud..."

**SUDIO:** "Nope."

**SUDIO:** "You're not leaving that gym anytime soon."

Lena almost smiles.

The call ends.

Lena sits there for a moment in the quiet.

Then picks up the main event poster.

She looks at it again.

This time, differently.



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Her eyes move from her own name to *Shimoda's*.

A long pause.

Then Lena crumples the card in her hand and drops it beside her.

